

Speaker 1: Yes, good evening again. Thank you very much for participating in this interview. As we mentioned in our message, we would like to learn more about your views on romantic relationships. We believe that your experience and your perspective will be very helpful for the project. Again, let me ask you in the recording. Is it okay for me to record this interview before we start?

Speaker 2: No problem, you can record it.

Speaker 1: I would like to reiterate that we will only use this recording for note taking and transcription. First of all, Ms. REDACTED, how old are you?

Speaker 2: [31-35]

Speaker 1: How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2: For [6-10] years, [6-10] years.

Speaker 1: Do you have children?

Speaker 2: We have [1-5] children.

Speaker 1: Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2: My children, my mother-in-law, my husband, me.

Speaker 1: What is your main source of income and your current job?

Speaker 2: Sir, I don't understand.

Speaker 1: What is your main source of income? Also, what is your current job?

Speaker 2: I am a [occupation] at the [company]. My husband is also a [occupation]. We both work, that is our income.

Speaker 1: And how would you like me to address your partner? Like husband, boyfriend, girlfriend.

Speaker 2: My husband.

Speaker 1: Can you tell me the story of when you first met your partner and how your relationship started?

Speaker 2: We were working at the same workplace, more precisely, we were working in the opposite rooms. As we met, we started to like each other. That's how we met, then our families met and got acquainted. We had such a marriage process.

Speaker 1: I would like to ask a few more questions if it's okay with you, when did you meet?

Speaker 2: We met in [Year]. We met towards the end of [Year]. We got married in [Year]. We knew each other before that but it was like... Hello, hello. We didn't have that much intimacy.

Speaker 1: So, how did your relationship develop? This is the process of becoming lovers, maybe the process of talking. Can you tell us a little bit more, if it is convenient for you?

Speaker 2: As we spent more time together, we started to get to know each other better. At that moment, these things can change. Characters emerge. What can I tell you, the interest and love

(sevgi) in my husband started to increase more. When there is more interest, there is more love (sevgi). This is how we started to be lovers. Finally, when we realized that we could get along, we decided to get married.

Speaker 1: So, how would you rate the quality of your own relationship with your partner compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2: My friends, I can say the same.

Speaker 1: Why do you think so? Do you want to open it? Why do you think it is the same quality?

Speaker 2: I mean, maybe because men change a little bit after marriage. It's not the same as in a relationship. You know, the interest shifts in different directions. I mean, you can become strangers in the same house most of the time. Or those conversations environments are gone. You know, when I look around, everyone is in the same situation now. Everyone is in a rush, everyone is struggling to survive, there are children. We have to pay attention to them. So I think it's at the same level.

Speaker 1: And can I also ask you how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2: You know, I didn't have much. [1-5] or [1-5].

Speaker 1: How would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2: We are more committed to each other. It was also different in the past. I am happy with my husband, thank God. I don't have any thoughts about the past like I wish I was with someone else. I mean, he understands me, we can talk more. I mean, how can I put it, when there is a problem, maybe we can't talk at the time, but later on we can tolerate each other with understanding. I mean, maybe in the past, if I had experienced the same, I would have continued with that person, but when there is such a problem, the lines are broken. My husband is more understanding than me. Because I am a little more impulsive, he is more submissive. For example, if there is resentment, he is always the one who takes the first step, or I should say most of the time. Because he is so understanding, I say it is better than the past.

Speaker 1: So what makes a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker 2: First of all respect. Then love (sevgi), of course. And our commitment to each other. What else can it be? Mostly love (sevgi), I mean, there will be love (sevgi), there will be respect. Commitment.

Speaker 1: What are the things that make low quality?

Speaker 2: What can it be? It could be constant contempt, humiliation. It could be a lack of love (sevgi). It could be indifference. It could be orientation outward, more orientation towards others.

Speaker 1: You said that what actually makes high quality is respect, love, commitment. Would you like to elaborate a little bit more on these concepts? Why do you think so? I wanted to know more about that.

Speaker 2: Respect is what keeps the relationship going. So if we always say something derogatory against each other. Then there is no love (sevgi), there is no commitment. How can I

put it, someone is constantly offending you. You cannot continue to love (sevmek) that person. What else? I don't know. Let me think about it.

Speaker 1: Please think as much as you want.

Speaker 2: Or I don't know. If you don't even love (sevgi) the child, the child will go away from you. He won't be interested in you. He wouldn't want to play with you. He wouldn't want to share his feelings with you. That's what love (sevgi) is like, that's what marriage requires. If your spouse does not love (sevgi) you, is not interested in you. Then after a while you start to lose touch. You look for love (sevgi) outside, in other people. That kind of thing.

Speaker 1: So would you say that high quality relationships for you are relationships where there is love, respect and commitment?

Speaker 2: Yes, that's right.

Speaker 1: So, how can a person know that they are in such a relationship?

Speaker 2: How can he understand that he is in such a relationship? I mean, I think he can tell by the way his partner behaves.

Speaker 1: Can you explain a little bit more? How can he behave, for example? How can the other party understand?

Speaker 2: He can say words of affection. Can show constant interest. He may ask how you are. He may want to spend more time with you, to share things with you. So then you know.

Speaker 1: So, when would you say was the most time your relationship was like this and when was the least time?

Speaker 2: I can say when my first child was born. Our attachment to each other, our love (sevgi) for each other increased, we learned to live more by sharing things. We took more responsibility. Even then we didn't wear ourselves out. It can happen at those times. At the times when it happens the least, material things get in the way. There are losses. We yell at each other. Then it becomes less.

Speaker 1: Well, you touched a little bit on these in your previous answers. But I'd like to ask you again if it's okay, what are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2: Yes, respect commitment.

Speaker 1: Yes, I will be repeating myself a little bit again, I'm sorry. But can you elaborate a little bit more on why you say that?

Speaker 2: I mean, how can I say? Same things. If my husband doesn't love (sevmek) me, if he doesn't care for me, I would get cold from him over time, frankly. He would get cold from me too. We wouldn't be not interested in each other. How can I put it? You know, we would tend to be with our friends more. We would tend to go out more. Or would be more oriented towards our children. We would become detached from each other, frankly. And this brings the marriage to an end. We would become like two strangers living in the same house. And that's the end of marriage.

Speaker 1: What is love according to you?

Speaker 2: How should I put it, if you get excited when you see someone, or if you always want to see them, if you always want to be with them, if you are very happy with them, if you don't need anyone else, I think that's love (aşk).

Speaker 1: So how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2: Well, maybe the first times it is important, but when love (sevgi) takes the place of love (aşk), love (sevgi) becomes more valuable. Because love (aşk) passes after a certain period of time. When that love (sevgi) is not there, you break up. Love (aşk) ends. Maybe you visualize that person in your imagination. At first, he presents himself differently. I'm telling you, men are like that most of the time. He always shows himself in a good light. That changes over time. If you don't have love (sevgi), love (aşk) ends after a certain period of time. I think it becomes unbearable.

Speaker 1: How do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2: How do I know that my husband loves me? My husband feels it to me. I can feel his love (sevgi) through his constant attention, his words, his behavior.

Speaker 1: So can you give an example? There may be moments when you feel like this. Or you know, an example, a concrete example? I mean when you realize that he loves you.

Speaker 2: I mean, when I cry, my husband actually cannot bear it. He immediately comes and hugs me. He doesn't want me to cry. Why are you crying? He always asks me insistently. You know, I am a type of person who can cry even if I watch a movie. He says "Why are you crying? What's wrong with that? What's the point of upsetting you? Why are you upsetting yourself?" I mean, he'll just turn off the movie I'm watching. I mean, he can't stand it when I'm sad. I feel his love (sevgi) in those moments. When I was worried about something, when the children were first born, when I was worried about whether I would be enough, whether I would be a mother, you know, my husband was constantly supporting me. At those times, I felt his love (sevgi) more. There may be examples like this.

Speaker 1: What would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2: I mean, the difficulties in our relationship, actually, I mean, we don't have many difficulties within ourselves, but how should I put it? I mean, a foreigner, I mean, since we live with my husband's mother, she has difficulties. The intervention of a stranger interfering in everything. Or it can be related to the children. Children get spoiled when they get everything they want. I don't want that. I want them to be a little more disciplined. We have problems like that. External factors usually cause our difficulties.

Speaker 1: Do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2: We fight.

Speaker 1: How often do you do it?

Speaker 2: I mean, we do it once a week.

Speaker 1: What are these fights about?

Speaker 2: It may be related to the children. For example, when my husband gets angry with the children, we fight. Or how should I put it, when my husband is irresponsible. For example,

when he doesn't pay attention to something, when he plays on the phone all the time, there are arguments between us. Take care of us a little more, take care of the house. Or if he wants to go out all the time, then we argue. We argue mostly because we want him to be a little bit more interested in the house.

Speaker 1: So how do you solve this fight?

Speaker 2: We usually sulk a little bit. Then we make up, we talk. We do it more after the anger passes. After a certain period of time, we solve it by talking. There are usually no problems that cannot be solved.

Speaker 1: So what are the other ways to maintain your relationship besides talking?

Speaker 2: I mean, for example, my husband makes me laugh. Even if I get angry, I laugh. Then we usually make up. Then he makes jokes like if you laugh then we made up. I have to listen to him. When he makes funny jokes, we make up.

Speaker 1: So would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Why?

Speaker 2: So despite the difficulties, we still support each other. We are always side by side. We do not give up on each other. I mean, if we want to break up, we can break up, but we don't want to break up. We also have children. We don't want to be separated from each.

Speaker 1: Well, I would be very grateful if you could exemplify these times when you support each other.

Speaker 2: Our support? For example, since my children are small, I often wake up at night and I have to take care of them all the time. Most of the time my husband says, "You sleep, I'll take care of them." Or how should I put it, he supports me in housework. We do it by sharing. We support each other mutually

Speaker 1: So has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2: Of course, I am a more patient person than I used to be. I mean, I don't care about things that I would have worried about more before. I mean, how can I say? How can it be? For example, when something happened with children, I used to worry a lot. I was wondering why they got sick. I was wondering why this happened. I was wondering if I wasn't good enough. Now I'm calmer. It can happen. Or when we first got married, my husband seemed a bit too childish at the time. You know, he settled down a bit. Over time, or I got used to it, I started to be more patient.

Speaker 1: Well, you touched on it a little bit, but do you think your partner changed during that relationship?

Speaker 2: Of course, he was more childish like that. I mean he was like a bachelor all the time. I mean, he wanted to eat, drink, travel and have fun. For example, he became more dependent on her home. Both financially and morally. There were always hand jokes. He used to make jokes. I mean, while it should have been appropriate, it was too much because it was happening

all the time. Time reduced them too. You know, he is a bit hyperactive. We regulated them a bit. It could have been during marriage or fatherhood. So he became a little more settled.

Speaker 1: I want to ask you again, do you think the person you were before your relationship is the same as the person you are now?

Speaker 2: No. I mean, before our relationship, I was a little bit more upright. I was a person with strict rules. I always wanted everything to be perfect. I mean, I would try to do the best I could. After we got married, it might be more like this It's okay if it's like this. We do those kinds of things.

Speaker 1: And do you think your partner is the same now as he/she was before the relationship?

Speaker 2: No. He has also changed a lot. You know, like I said, he is more settled. He is attached to her home. He is attached to his children. More fatherly. More experienced. Okay, maybe his love (sevgi) has increased, but how can I say? His interest has increased. I mean, his childishness has decreased. And as he got older, maybe he became a little more mature.

Speaker 1: Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Can you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2: I mean I feel safe, I have a husband who will pick me up when I fall. I mean, he makes me feel that he is always there for me in the smallest troubles. Sometimes even a hug from a person is enough. Even if I can't do anything, just that support is enough. Honestly, this makes me feel safe.

Speaker 1: So can you give an example of a time when you felt like this?

Speaker 2: I mean, how did I feel safe? Let me see. I can't think of anything right now. For example, there are times when I get very tired at home. At least I can say that I have a husband to help me. I trust him a lot. Or when I'm in financial trouble, I trust my husband. I say he's my supporter. When I'm going to start a business, I say he's there. So it could be like that. Maybe, I can't give an example, these are the ones I can think of right now.

Speaker 1: Yes, I'm going to do a screen share for my next question and I want to ask you guys a little bit in a visual way, I'm going to ask you for a second, can you see my screen?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: If I ask you that my partner usually really listens to me. Which option between one and nine would you choose?

Speaker 2: He usually really listens to me. Eight.

Speaker 1: So for this question, if I ask you that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs.

Speaker 2: Usually, seven. I call this one seven.

Speaker 1: Thank you very much. Actually, yes. In my first question, you answered eight because my partner usually really listens to me. I'm going to ask you why you answered eight.

Speaker 2: I mean, when I have a problem, I tell him directly. He even gives me advice like “If you think like that, what I think may be different. You might be thinking wrong”. Actually, he might have done it like this. I had a problem with someone. I experienced this, for example, I experienced something like this during the day. I say this upset me. Then, when my husband looks at it from another perspective, it may be different. I might have thought wrong. I mean, he usually listens.

Speaker 1: You actually gave some examples, but I would appreciate it if you could give some more concrete examples of these moments.

Speaker 2: Concrete example. I mean, let me put it like this. I tell my husband not to speak too loudly to the children. He listens to me. Let me say why and how. I tell the children not to buy too much, you know, don't buy everything they want, every moment, I mean, we can buy but this time they become insatiable. Because it happens every time they want it. For example, when I told this to him, he started to step back a little more. At least he started to take one when he used to take three. Or he lowered his voice a little more. He started to pay attention to his actions. I mean, he had thoughts like, “I wonder if I'm behaving wrong”.

Speaker 1: So why eight and not seven or nine?

Speaker 2: Because it is a middle ground. I mean, not always. For example, when I tell him not to do that, he decides on his own. He doesn't necessarily say that he wants to do what I say. He listens to my ideas, but he acts a little more on his own. That's why.

Speaker 1: So why not seven.

Speaker 2: If he doesn't do it at all, then I would say seven, or we can say lower.

Speaker 1: Yes, actually I'm going to ask a bit similar questions, this time for our second question. For my parties are usually sensitive to my needs. You have chosen seven as appropriate. I will ask why you answered seven.

Speaker 2: I mean like this. I say something but he doesn't apply it much. I think a little bit more about his needs. I tell him. But he is aware of it, for example, I say my need, he sometimes implements it, sometimes he doesn't. That's why I said seven, to be honest.

Speaker 1: Okay. Can you give concrete examples of when these things happened?

Speaker 2: Your voice is gone, can I hear it again?

Speaker 1: Can you give some concrete examples of when this happened?

Speaker 2: How can I say? For example, sometimes I say “you don't tell me you love me, you don't pay attention to me”. Then I guess he doesn't feel like it, he does too many things. But after a few days he starts to behave differently. He shows more interest. That's why. That's what I can say.

Speaker 1: So why not seven or nine, oh sorry. Not six or eight but seven.

Speaker 2: So like I said, it is the same again. I said seven because it's in the middle. Not as low as a six. But not as high as an eight. So it doesn't do everything I want or everything... How should I put it? I mean, it doesn't do everything I want, everything I say. In that sense. Medium.

Speaker 1: I hope you don't mind me asking this question and if it is a sensitive subject for you to share, please feel free to tell me. But I would also like to know about your intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2: So it's medium these days. Do I need to specify the number?

Speaker 1: I mean, however you see fit, frankly.

Speaker 2: So we have the option of not answering that question?

Speaker 1: Yes, so you don't have to answer.

Speaker 2: Then I don't want to answer that question.

Speaker 1: Okay. I have one more question. Again, you can decide if you want. How satisfied are you with your sexual life then?

Speaker 2: I mean. Then I shouldn't answer this question either, it's a bit personal. I'm sorry.

Speaker 1: No problem. Yes. Once again, I will share one last screen with you.

Speaker 2: Okay.

Speaker 1: If I ask you how satisfied you are with your relationship in general, which one would you consider appropriate?

Speaker 2: I am very satisfied.

Speaker 1: Okay. If I ask you to rate the satisfaction of your relationship on a scale of 0 to 10 this time.

Speaker 2: 9

Speaker 1: Thank you very much. Yes, actually I think you can guess what I am going to ask. Why 9?

Speaker 2: Shall I tell you my answer? I am waiting for you to ask me again.

Speaker 1: I was asking a question and I think I lost my voice. I'm sorry.

Speaker 2: Then can we take the question again?

Speaker 1: Yes. Why? If you are completely or, oh, I'm so sorry. The satisfaction of your relationship. How would you rate it and you answered 9 on a scale of 0 to 10? Why did you answer 9?

Speaker 2: I gave a score of 9 because not everything is perfect and flawless.

Speaker 1: Okay. Why? 9 and not 8 and 10.

Speaker 2: So everything like this, how shall I put it, you want an illustration. Let me put it this way. Not everything is a bed of roses. If we look at the way we live in our lives, I mean, it's okay because we don't have everything we want. We try to adapt. But it doesn't always happen at every point we want. First part of it is me moving forward, part of it is my husband moving forward. He takes a step towards me. That's why I marked one lower, 9, not completely.

Speaker 1: So did your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker 2: Yes. I mean partially. In the majority, yes.

Speaker 1: I'm about to finish, actually I'd like to summarize what we talked about in the last hour, if that's okay with you. You have [1-5] children. You are [31-35] years old. You mentioned that you met your husband at the same workplace in different offices and then you became lovers in [Year] and got married in [Year]. You responded that as you spend time and interest grows, so does love, and so your relationship has actually developed. You said that the quality of your relationship was the same compared to your friends' relationship. You also mentioned that things can change after marriage. You described your current relationship as one in which you can communicate and talk more about addiction compared to your former romantic relationships. And you mentioned that what makes a relationship high quality for you is respect, love and dependency. You actually defined love for you as being excited, always wanting to see him, always wanting to see him, being happy with him. And you talked about the value of love in a relationship, with love being more important at first, and then the value of affection. You mentioned that your parties are about making him feel that he loves you with his attention and his words. You mentioned that he made you laugh about other ways of maintaining your relationship besides talking. Through this relationship you become more patient, more calm about things. You mentioned that your partner has likewise become a more grounded individual who is more attached to his/her home thanks to this relationship, this relationship. You mentioned that both of you have changed. Was this true? Is there anything you would like to add?

Speaker 2: That is correct, absolutely correct. There is nothing else to add.

Speaker 1: Finally, how much did you feel uncomfortable while I was asking these questions?

Speaker 2: I was very comfortable.

Speaker 1: I am very happy. Thank you very much again. Before we finish I would like to talk about how we are going to handle the data. As a research project we want to be as transparent with you as ethically possible and therefore I would like you to decide which option of sharing the data is the most appropriate for you. The first option is to share parts of the transcript of our interview. None of these transcripts will contain any identifiable information. In this way, the de-identification of our interview transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option, if it is convenient for you and if you want to be a bit brave, is to share our interview transcript in the same way, by removing sensitive and overly identifying details, that is, by anonymizing it. In this option, there is a slim chance that someone who knows you well will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down who you are among your colleagues. Again, I would expect that no sensitive information will be shared under either option. Which option do you prefer?

Speaker 2: So it could be the second option.

Speaker 1: Yes again, thank you very much for participating in this study. I would like you to know that this study has been conducted in Philippines, Brazil, Iceland, France and USA. We have one last request for this study to be successful. Can you suggest two close people in your life as candidates? We will ask them to suggest couples you don't know who might be interested

in this study, and in this way we aim to reach as many different participants as possible. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker 2: For a suggestion? Applicable.

Speaker 1: Thank you. If it is convenient for you, we can discuss with the people you can suggest through these people. Of course, of course, their acceptance is very valuable. If they accept, we would also be very happy if you could give us a little information about this work so that we do not make them nervous when we call.

Speaker 2: Okay, I will inform you. I will contact you via [Social Media]. I will let you know if they want to participate.

Speaker 1: All right. Then I will stop the recording if it is convenient for you. I'm very sorry, not the interview, the recording. Unless there is something you want to say in the recording.

Speaker 1: Thank you.